

Cadmium

48
Cd

During the refining and production of zinc from its ore, cadmium is extracted as an impurity. This metal was once used to make vibrant yellow paint, but it is no longer used as it is now known to be highly toxic. Today, cadmium is used mainly in rechargeable batteries.

ATOMIC MASS 112.414

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1817
(Friedrich Stromeyer)

*This mineral is mainly composed
of cadmium sulfide.*

Greenockite, an ore of cadmium



Hafnium

72
Hf

Chemists knew there was a gap in the periodic table, underneath zirconium, but couldn't find the missing element for many years. Hafnium was eventually found in crystals of a mineral called zircon. It was discovered to be nearly identical to zirconium, which was also present in the crystals.

ATOMIC MASS 178.49

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1923 (George Charles de Hevesy and Dirk Coster)

**Laboratory
sample of
pure hafnium**

